quite being seen to be going through the motions.

In truth, I know only one way to play the game. It's the way I played every game with my brothers in the back garden at 20 Mentz Avenue, and it's the way I have approached every single one of the 106 Test matches, 200 ODIs and 71 T20 internationals that I have played for South Africa, so far.

Give everything, always. Hold nothing back, always. Put the team first, always. Play through pain, always. Fight and fight again, always. Always, always play the game with the hunger, the enthusiasm and the appetite of the eight-year-old *laaitjie*, the youngest brother, who would run into the garden to play with his older brothers and their friends, relishing the challenge, loving every minute of the contest.

That's the way I play. That's the way I have always played. That's the only way I know how to play. When the day dawns that I can't play this way, when my shoulder or my knee or my ankle is too sore, when I can't generate the same hunger, enthusiasm and appetite, that will be the day I decide to stop playing the game.

This all-or-nothing approach could mean my international career ends sooner than that of others, but I would much rather be the guy who gave everything whenever he played than be the guy who somehow paced himself to play for, say, 16 years. Others will have a different view, and they may be right. I am just explaining my outlook.

To use an analogy, imagine my career as a racing car with a full tank of petrol. Ever since 2004, I have driven that car just about as fast as it can go, foot pressed down on the accelerator, shaving every corner, endlessly going for broke and now, moving into my thirties, there is only so much petrol left in the tank.

When the petrol runs out, that will be that. The racing car will come to a halt. Some may say I should start to drive more conservatively, be prepared to pull back at times and even to freewheel on the clutch, conserve energy, and so make what remains of the petrol last for longer. The point is I can't do that.